Dear Halden Pay Hiring Team,

I am applying for the Senior Data Engineer – Data Platform role. I have experience owning and operating production data platforms and cloud data warehouses, and I'm drawn to the opportunity to build reusable platform capabilities that support analysts, data scientists and product teams.

At Lukovac Freight Hub, I own ingestion and orchestration across a platform built using Python and SQL alongside Airflow, Snowflake, dbt and Kafka, with incremental dbt models, documented transformations and CI-based testing. I designed a shipment-event pipeline processing around 30 million events per day, with end-to-end latency under two minutes at p95. I also migrated approximately 300 stored procedures to documented, tested dbt models, introducing incremental models and CI that reduced the nightly warehouse build from 5 hours 10 minutes to 1 hour 35 minutes. Replacing hourly full-table extracts with Debezium CDC reduced replica CPU during loads from around 70% to 25%. This work improved platform reliability through dead-letter and replay tooling, strengthened data quality through tested dbt models, and simplified operations through documented transformations and CI.

My earlier experience at Kovalent Pay is also relevant to Halden Pay's business. I designed Redshift cloud data warehouse solutions, developed PySpark batch jobs on AWS EMR, and worked with incremental data models and materialized-view concepts. I also worked with Great Expectations for data quality. I built a transaction reconciliation engine matching bank settlement files against internal ledgers, reducing the finance team's manual reconciliation from around three days to four hours per month-end. I hold an AWS Certified Data Engineer – Associate certification and an MSc in Computer Science, with a thesis on incremental materialized views. I have also contributed two merged pull requests to an open-source Airflow provider, including a fix and tests.

Halden Pay's focus on shared data infrastructure and its values of Together, Ownership and Pace resonate with how I approach data engineering. I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how my experience with platform operations, data modelling, cloud warehouses and open-source contributions could support your Data Platform team.

Kind regards,

Lena Varga-Holm